

MLOps MENA Community - Ultimate FAQ

Course Administration & Logistics

- **Schedule & Platform:** Live sessions are broadcast on YouTube every Sunday from 7:00 PM to 10:00 PM GMT+3. If your Zomra calendar displays GMT+2, adjust your profile time zone settings to GMT+3.
- **Session Availability:** Session 1 will remain on the YouTube channel permanently. Subsequent recordings will be removed after 1 week or before the next session begins.
- **Attendance & Certificates:** The attendance form is linked in the YouTube video description and remains open throughout the course. To submit it, you must enter the secret 'code word' announced during the live session; sharing this code word in public chats is strictly prohibited. An Attendance Certificate requires submitting all five weekly forms, whereas a Project Certificate is awarded exclusively upon completing the Final Project.
- **Special Circumstances:** Exceptions for missing sessions or deadlines are granted for members in Gaza, mandatory military service, or severe emergencies. Affected members should contact the administration directly.

Projects & Study Groups

- **Mini-Projects:** Weekly assignments (e.g., containerizing an ML API using Pytest, Docker, and structured logging) are optional but strongly recommended to bridge the gap between theory and practical application.
- **Final Project:** Mandatory for the Project Certificate; one of the available options involves building an Arabic Legal Document Q&A system.

Study Group Tracks

Study Group Track	Target Audience & Prerequisites	Focus Areas	Registration Info
1: Beginner	Junior ML/DS; knows Python/ML basics; new to Docker/Cloud.	Git, Linux, Docker, APIs, basic CI/CD.	https://chat.whatsapp.com/HuaUwrKvvRu6oPKYd3zgU1?s=cl&p=i&ilr=4&amv=0
2: Intermediate	Backend/Software Engineers; handles APIs; knows Git/Docker.	Model Serving, MLflow, Airflow, Deployment.	https://chat.whatsapp.com/CtNc1LsLdf71siNeHX2D1D?s=cl&p=i&ilr=4&amv=0
3: Advanced/Cloud	Hands-on Cloud experience	Kubernetes, Terraform, Scalability, Monitoring.	https://chat.whatsapp.com/HBs4YZzpyCdGV3

Study Group Track	Target Audience & Prerequisites	Focus Areas	Registration Info
	(AWS/GCP/Azure); knows Kubernetes.		wnA0pAx0?s=cl&p=i&ilr=4&amv=0
4: DevOps to MLOps	DevOps, Cloud, or SRE professionals lacking ML knowledge.	ML Lifecycle, Model Registry, MLOps Architecture.	https://chat.whatsapp.com/L0ZXg3qdY1QLwN07N5yryV?s=cl&p=i&ilr=4&amv=0

Note: Members must join a study group based on their actual hands-on technical experience, not their official job titles. Forming unauthorized study groups outside of community supervision is not allowed.

Technical Requirements & Setup

- **Prerequisites:** Students must understand supervised machine learning and have built at least one basic model. Familiarity with Python Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) is a must for large projects.
- **Environment & OS:** Avoid using heavy Virtual Machines; Windows users should enable WSL2 (Ubuntu) for optimal Docker integration. Be aware that WSL2 instances can grow large and quickly consume C: drive space, so monitor your storage. Online alternatives like Docker Playground are also viable options.
- **Deployment & Best Practices:** Use .env files to securely manage variables between staging and production environments (e.g., via GitLab variables), ensuring you ignore the main .env file while pushing an .env_example. Additionally, avoid using Pickle for model serialization; transition to ONNX for safer and faster production inference.

Official Resources & Important Links

Resource Name	Description
Course GitHub Repo	Contains all session codes, Python scripts, and slides. [https://github.com/MLOpsMENACommunity/ml_ops_practitioner_course]
Projects Guide	Details deliverables, datasets, and prerequisites for all Mini and Final projects. [https://drive.google.com/file/d/1NTXz0iNCPitlRezNLLqeDms8SVUZ8MGW/view]
Discord Server	The primary, organized channel for technical questions and support. [https://discord.gg/BSsQCzSMc]
Zomra Platform	https://zomra.io/courses/the-mlops-practitioner
Community Form	Anonymous Google form to submit recurring questions or suggestions. [https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdvFTE1ZGZRwn3cS]

Resource Name	Description
	ewpd7AEjrzi1-KesQyMLof_7C_tlqSSQ/viewform?usp=publish-editor
LinkedIn Page	https://www.linkedin.com/company/mlops-mena/
Community Beta Website	http://mlopsmena.com/

Official Channels & Live Sessions

- YouTube & Live Streams:** Live sessions run every Sunday from 7:00 PM to 10:00 PM (GMT+3). All session recordings (including extra sessions like Docker) are uploaded to a dedicated playlist named "The MLOps Practitioner Course":
 - Session 1 Live Stream (Permanent): <https://www.youtube.com/live/rJFIn83w0Dc>]
 - Session 2 Live Stream: <https://www.youtube.com/live/slXkWpCAqI8>]
 - Session 3 Live Stream: https://www.youtube.com/live/N3v8va_P0DE]
 - Session 4 Live Stream: <https://youtube.com/live/i7jT4Dr6qgE?feature=share>]
 - Session 5 Live Stream: https://youtube.com/live/_rfZUcMQFeg?feature=share]